

Knowledge Checkpoint: Match the Level

Half-A4 Handout

Name: _____ Date: _____ Class: _____ Score: _____ / 4

Task: Match each scenario card to its correct level of ecological organisation. Draw a line from the card to the target box, or write the level in each card slot.

The Targets

Match 1	Individual A single living organism of one species.
Match 2	Population All individuals of the same species in a habitat.
Match 3	Community All interacting populations of different species.
Match 4	Ecosystem Living community interacting with abiotic factors.

The Scenario Cards

Scenario A All the frogs, lily pads, insects, and the pond water they live in. Level: _____	Scenario B Every single European badger currently living in a specific woodland. Level: _____
Scenario C One specific red fox. Level: _____	Scenario D The badgers, foxes, earthworms, and oak trees living in the woodland. Level: _____

Self Assessment: ☐ Needs Review ☐ Got It ☐ Can Teach It

Teacher Checked: ☐ Complete

✂ CUT ALONG LINE (2 HANDOUTS PER A4 PAGE) ✂

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Knowledge Checkpoint: Match the Level — Answer Key

Official OCR Gateway Biology B7.1b Criteria and Common Examiner Distinctions

Scenario	Scenario Description	Correct Level	Marks	Examiner Guidance
Card A	All the frogs, lily pads, insects, and the pond water they live in.	Ecosystem	1 Mark	Crucial clue is <i>pond water</i> . The inclusion of abiotic physical factors alongside biotic living organisms defines an ecosystem.
Card B	Every single European badger currently living in a specific woodland.	Population	1 Mark	All individuals of a <i>single species</i> (<i>Meles meles</i>) in a defined location at the same time.
Card C	One specific red fox.	Individual	1 Mark	A single discrete organism representing the lowest tier of the hierarchy.
Card D	The badgers, foxes, earthworms, and oak trees living in the woodland.	Community	1 Mark	Multiple interacting populations of <i>different species</i> inhabiting the same habitat without physical abiotic factors.

Key Examiner Guidance & Misconceptions:

- Community vs. Ecosystem:** Award mark for *Ecosystem* on Card A only because "pond water" is explicitly stated. If only the organisms were named (frogs, lily pads, insects), it would be a *Community*.
- Population vs. Species:** A species is the global group capable of interbreeding; a *population* is strictly localized (all badgers in that specific woodland).
- Pedagogical Progression:** Individual → Population → Community → Ecosystem → Biosphere.